

Stacking Context Bug Hunt

Hypothesis / Evidence

Bug	Visible symptom	My prediction	AI hypotheses / testing	What I observed	Result	Minimal repair
1. Badge containing block	The "New" badge was showing up away from the card instead of sitting inside the top-right corner.	I thought the problem had something to do with the badge being absolutely positioned and the card not being set up as the thing it should position against.	AI looked at if the badge itself was positioned wrong, the inset values were wrong, or if the card was not acting as the containing block.	In DevTools, the badge was position: absolute, but the .card had no position rule. When I temporarily added position: relative to the card, the badge moved into the correct spot right away.	Confirmed: the card was not acting as the badge's containing block.	I added position: relative; to .card.
2. Trapped callout	The yellow callout had a really high z-index, but it was still showing behind the maroon neighboring panel.	I thought the callout was getting trapped inside the stacking context of .context-low, so the z-index: 999 on the callout could not actually put it above the other panel.	AI tested if transform: translateZ(0) was causing the issue, z-index: 1 on .context-low was causing it, or if the callout just needed a bigger z-index.	Turning off only transform: translateZ(0) did not change anything, so that was not the only cause. When I also turned off z-index: 1, the callout moved in front of the neighboring panel.	Confirmed: lower stacking context from .context-low..	I removed the unnecessary stacking-context triggers from .context-low instead of adding a larger z-index.
3. Blocked link	Clicking "Go to destination" with the mouse did nothing, even though the link looked normal.	I thought the decorative overlay was sitting on top of the link and blocking mouse clicks.	AI considered whether the link itself was broken, the overlay was covering it, or if the z-index relationship was preventing interaction.	The link worked when I used Tab and pressed Enter, so the link itself was fine. In DevTools, the decorative overlay covered the whole card with position: absolute, inset: 0, and z-index: 2. When I added pointer-events: none, mouse clicks could pass through the overlay.	Confirmed: the decorative overlay was blocking pointer interaction.	I added pointer-events: none; to .decorative-overlay.
4. Sticky heading / focus target	When jumping to the focus target, it could land too close to the top where the sticky heading was taking up space.	I thought the target needed extra scroll space so the browser would not place it underneath or right against the sticky heading.	AI tested whether the sticky position itself was the issue and whether the target's scroll-margin-top: 0 was the problem. At the normal viewport size, the issue was hard to see, so I tested again with a shorter viewport.	At about 1200 × 600 with scroll-margin-top: 0, the target landed right up against the top area. After changing it to 7rem, the target landed lower and stayed clear of the sticky heading.	Confirmed: the target needed scroll margin to account for the sticky heading.	I changed #focus-target from scroll-margin-top: 0 to scroll-margin-top: 7rem.